

Proposal for Emoji: Jain Ahimsa Hand & Jain Om character

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Abstract

This proposal requests the addition of 2 new emojis to the Unicode consortium Emoji library, representing the Jain faith. Diversifying the options for representing the Jain religion fills the gap for a diverse cultural and inclusive representation of all faiths. As other religions have their own symbol within the Emoji library, this proposal aims to provide completeness for the Jain community to communicate their beliefs.

(Note on demographic data for the Unicode consortium jury: Jainism is a distinct, ancient religion that is still very prominent as of today, with millions of followers mainly from India. It had and still has a massive cultural footprint on today's various cultures, including other religions that came afterwards, such as Buddhism).

1. Identification

A. Emoji proposal 1: JAIN AHIMSA HAND

Proposed CLDR short name: jain-ahimsa-hand

Proposed CLDR English keywords: non-violence | peace | protection | mudra | jain-hand | wheel-hand | religion | no-harm | ethical | vegan | animal-rights | cruelty-free

Proposed category: religion

Description: The Ahimsa hand is a prominent Jain symbol, but this proposal also focuses on the modern application of its meaning. *Ahimsa* means non-violence and therefore could co-exist in other contexts such as: veganism, animal rights and cruelty-free.

Its inclusion would serve the completeness of all religious communities by incorporating the Jain religion, whose population is similar in scale than other represented religious groups (e.g. the Star of David emoji 🌠 (Star of David, U+2721 U+FE0F) for 15M Jewish people, the Khanda emoji 🪦 (Khanda, U+1FAAF) for 30M Sikh people or the Shinto Shrine emoji 🏛️ (Shinto shrine, U+26E9 U+FE0F) for 3M Shinto people).

This symbol also fills a gap to the global communities dedicated to ethical and non-violent living, such as: Jain people (4,000,000 to 6,000,000 people), vegan people (1% of the whole population, roughly 80,000,000 people), dharmic non-Jains such as Hindus and Buddhists (roughly 1,500,000,000 people), cruelty-free consumers (a \$14,840,000,000 market in 2023 [according to Grand View Research](#)) and animal rights activists.



B. Emoji proposal 2: JAIN OM CHARACTER

Proposed CLDR short name: jain-om

Proposed CLDR English keywords: jainism | aum | aaaum | paramesthi | meditation | dharma | liberation | soul

Proposed category: religion

Description: The Jain Om (Aaaum) is a sacred character that represents the combination of all five Pañca-Parameṣṭhi supreme beings in Jainism. Despite sounding similar to the Hindu Om emoji  (Om, U+1F549 U+FE0F), they are visually and theologically different. They both share the sacred sound of the Dharmic meditation, but the Jain Om (Aaaum) is a composite symbol of five vowels whereas the Hindu one is derived from the "O" Devanagari sound.



2. Images

License: We certify that the images were created by the submitter in April 2026 and are hereby released into the public domain.

3. Factors for Inclusion

A. Expresses multiple concepts

Does the emoji have notable metaphorical references or symbolism?



JAIN AHIMSA HAND

- **Yes.** *Ahimsa hand* also expresses the notion of cruelty-free, pacifism, veganism, the concept of "stop and think before acting" and the Wheel of Dharma. Its meaning is meaningful for other movements such as vegan people (1% of the whole population, roughly 80,000,000 people), cruelty-free consumers (a \$14,840,000,000 market in 2023 [according to Grand View Research](#)) and animal rights activists.



JAIN OM CHARACTER

- **Yes.** The symbolism of the Jain Om (Aaum) character is defined as the five stages of the soul liberation path.
- Its sound is purposefully similar to the Hindu Om, a population of roughly 1,000,000,000 people.

B. Use in sequences

Can the emoji be used well in sequences?



JAIN AHIMSA HAND

- **Yes.** Used with 🍖 (Cut of Meat, U+1F969) to express veganism. Used with 🕊️ (Dove of Peace, U+1F54A U+FE0F) or ☮️ (Peace Symbol, U+262E U+FE0F) or ✌️ (Victory Hand, U+270C U+FE0F) to express peace.



JAIN OM CHARACTER

- **Yes.** Used with ॐ (Om, U+1F549 U+FE0F) and 🌀 (Wheel of Dharma, U+2638 U+FE0F) to express Dharmic interfaith. Used with 🙏 (Folded hands, U+1F64F), 👐 (Palms Up Together, U+1F932) to express faith rituals, or 🛕 (Place of Worship, U+1F6D0) for temple representation.

C. Breaks new ground

Does the emoji represent something that is new and different?



JAIN AHIMSA HAND

- **Yes.** The symbols for 🖐️ (Hamsa, U+1FAAC) and 🙌 (Raised Hand with Fingers Splayed, U+1F590 U+FE0F) do not include the Dharma wheel that represents the concept of non-violence.



JAIN OM CHARACTER

- **Yes.** Jainism hasn't been proposed yet, nor declined, nor has it been ever represented in Unicode standards. Jainism lacks any basic representation despite being a major religion.

D. Distinctiveness

Explain how and why your emoji represents a distinct, recognizable, visually iconic entity.



JAIN AHIMSA HAND

- The inclusion of the 24-rays Chakra wheel, the Ahimsa symbol, in the center of the left-handed open palm is distinct from other iconographies.



JAIN OM CHARACTER

- Features a distinct crescent representing the Siddhashila (apex of the universe), the dot represents the soul, and the rest represents the combination of all 5 supreme beings' first character (Arihant + Ashiri + Acarya + Upadhyaya + Muni) which in turns forms the sound "Aaaum".

Here are some real-world Jain symbol representations, photographed by the submitters from places in Karnataka, India:



JAIN AHIMSA HAND

Note to the jury: the Ahimsa hand is prominently featured in the Jain Trilok symbol, which is the official emblem adopted by all branches of Jainism (Digambara and Svetambara) in the 1974 unification for the 2,500th anniversary of Mahavira's nirvana. This means this symbol is non-sectarian.

The reason the Jain Trilok symbol isn't featured in this proposal is it contains a swastika that would generate unnecessary debate around the true meaning of the symbol. Our goal is to represent the Jain faith into the Unicode emoji set, and this symbol remains misunderstood in many parts of the world as of today.



Figure 1: Gold ring



Figure 2: Fence of a Jain temple



Figure 3: Wood engraved on a door



Figure 4: Popular sticker on a minivan



Figure 5: Marble engraved on a house inaugural plate



Figure 6: Illustration from a wedding proposal



Figure 7: Flag in front of a Jain temple



Figure 8: Logotype of a Jain event in Bidarur

JAIN OM CHARACTER



Figure 9: Jain temple pillar engraving



Figure 10: Sticker on a motorbike

ಪರಿಶಿಷ್ಟ - 1

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ಜೈನ ಪರಂಪರೆಯ ಅನುಸಾರ ಸಮೃತ 'ಓಂ'ನ ಪ್ರಾಚೀನ ಲಿಪಿಯಲ್ಲಿ ಚಿಹ್ನೆ. ಜೈನ ಶಬ್ದದಲ್ಲಿ 'ಜ', 'ನ', ಹಾಗೂ 'ಜ'ದ ಮೇಲೆ 'ಐ'ಗೆ ಎರಡು ಮಾತ್ರಗಳು ಇರುತ್ತವೆ. ಇವುಗಳ ಮಧ್ಯಮದಿಂದ 'ಓಂ' ಚಿಹ್ನೆಯನ್ನು ಮಾಡಲಾಗುತ್ತದೆ. 'ಓಂ'ನ ಪ್ರತೀಕ ಚಿಹ್ನೆ ಮಾಡುವ ವಿಧಿಯು ಹೀಗಿದೆ.

Figure 11: Kannada book explaining the Jain "Aum" symbol composition

E. Usage level

Measures that can be presented as evidence

• Google Search

197,000,000 results for "jain", 63,400,000 results for "jain om" & 6,530,000 results for "ahimsa" compared to 436,000,000 results for "elephant"

Google

jain

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AI Overview

Jainism is an ancient Indian religion (Jain Dharma) emphasizing non-violence (*ahimsa*), non-attachment (*aparigraha*), and pluralism (*anekantavada*) to achieve spiritual purity. Primarily followers of 24 Tirthankaras, Jains form a distinct, highly literate community, with major populations in Maharashtra, Rajasthan, and

Any country

Any time

All results

Advanced Search

About 19,70,00,000 results (0.31s)

Google

jain om

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Images

Any language

Any time

All results

Advanced Search

About 6,34,00,000 results (0.37s)

G

ahimsa

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AI Overview

ahimsa

/əˈhɪmsɑː/

Ahimsa is the ancient Indian principle of total non-violence, compassion, and harmlessness in thought, speech, and action towards all living beings. Central

Any language

Any time

All results

Advanced Search

About 65,30,000 results (0.38s)

Wikipedia



elephant



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See results
about



African elephants
Animal



Elephants
Animal



Elephant

Animal

- Any country
- Any time
- All results
- Advanced Search

About 43,60,00,000 results (0.68s)

47,400,000 results for "jain", 3,200,000 results for "jain om" & 745,000 results for "ahimsa" compared to 90,300,000 results for "elephant"



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[Shraddha Jain - OM Chanting 108 Times | Healing ...](#)
 VERY POWERFUL **OM** CHANTS The vibration produced by ch
 the physical universe corresponds to the original vibration that fi
 YouTube · OnClick Bhajans · 21 Sept 2015

[www.youtube.com › watch](#)



[Navkar Mahamantra | Om Namo Arihantanam | Jain Stavan ...](#)
 Navkar Maha Mantra | Om Namo Arihantanam | Jain Stavan | | Radhika Jain

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About 32,00,000 results (0.40s)



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Dr. Sahar Joakim, What is Ahimsa?



Here, Sahar Joakim briefly discusses ahimsa. For more, visit www.saharjoakim.net.

YouTube · Sahar Joakim · 24 Apr 2024


[4 key moments in this video ▾](#)

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About 7,45,000 results (0.38s)



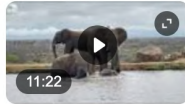
elephant



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The Elephant Herd Loving the First Spring Rains



Carer Owen captures a peaceful morning with the herd as they enjoy a chilly morning swim. The air is still cool from the night.

YouTube · HERD Elephant Orphanage South Africa · 3 Nov

www.youtube.com › watch

Baby Elephant Has The Happiest Reaction To Her First Swim..



Baby Elephant Has The Happiest Reaction To Her First Swim! | Cuddle

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About 9,03,00,000 results (0.22s)

Google Trends: Web Search

● elephant
Search term

● jain
Search term

● jain om
Search term

● ahimsa
Search term

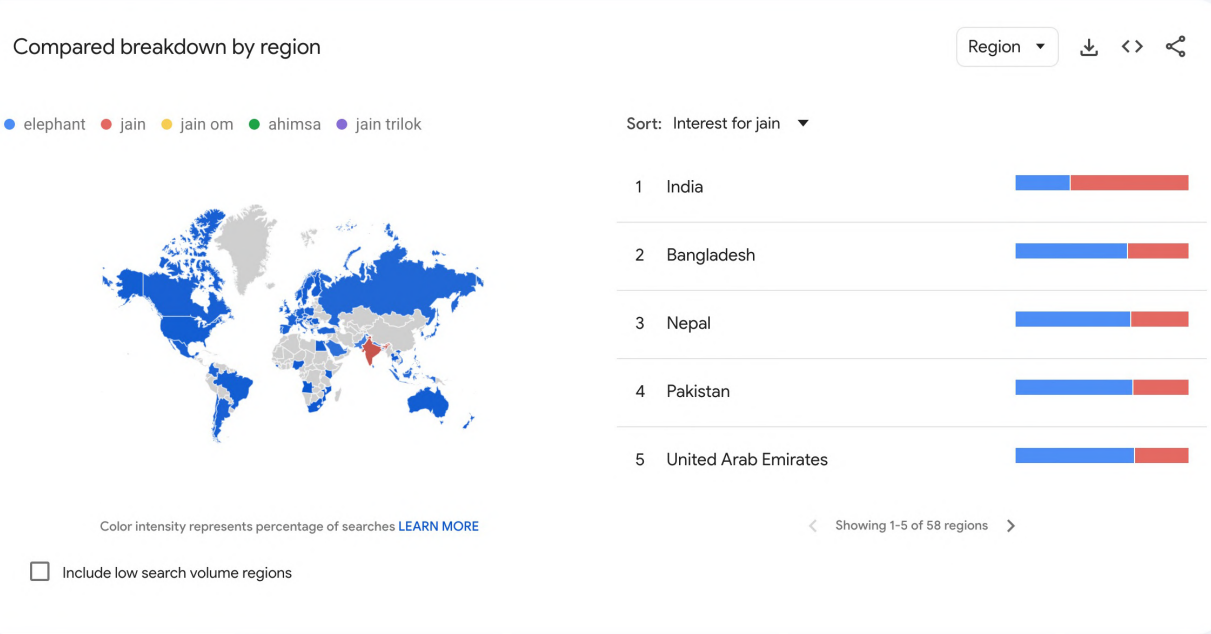
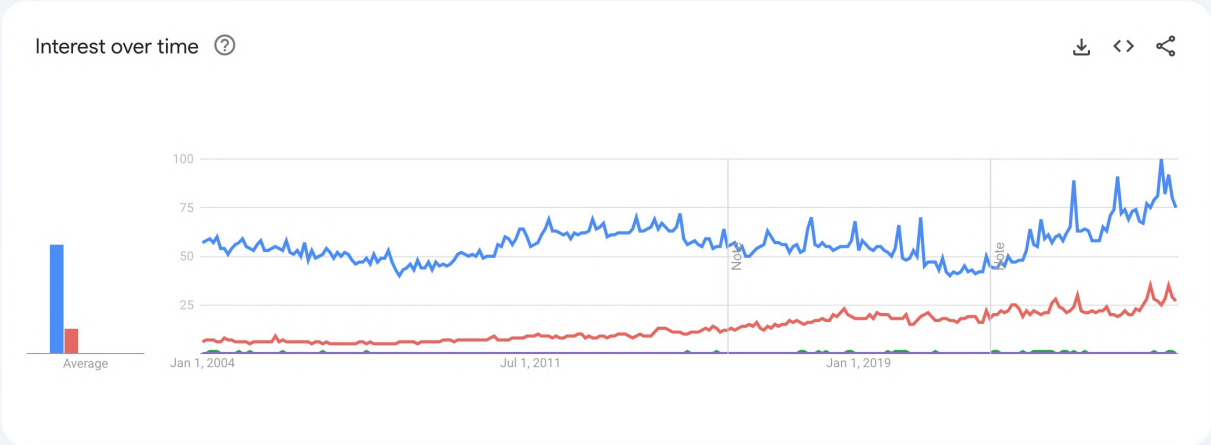
● jain trilok
Search term

Worldwide ▾

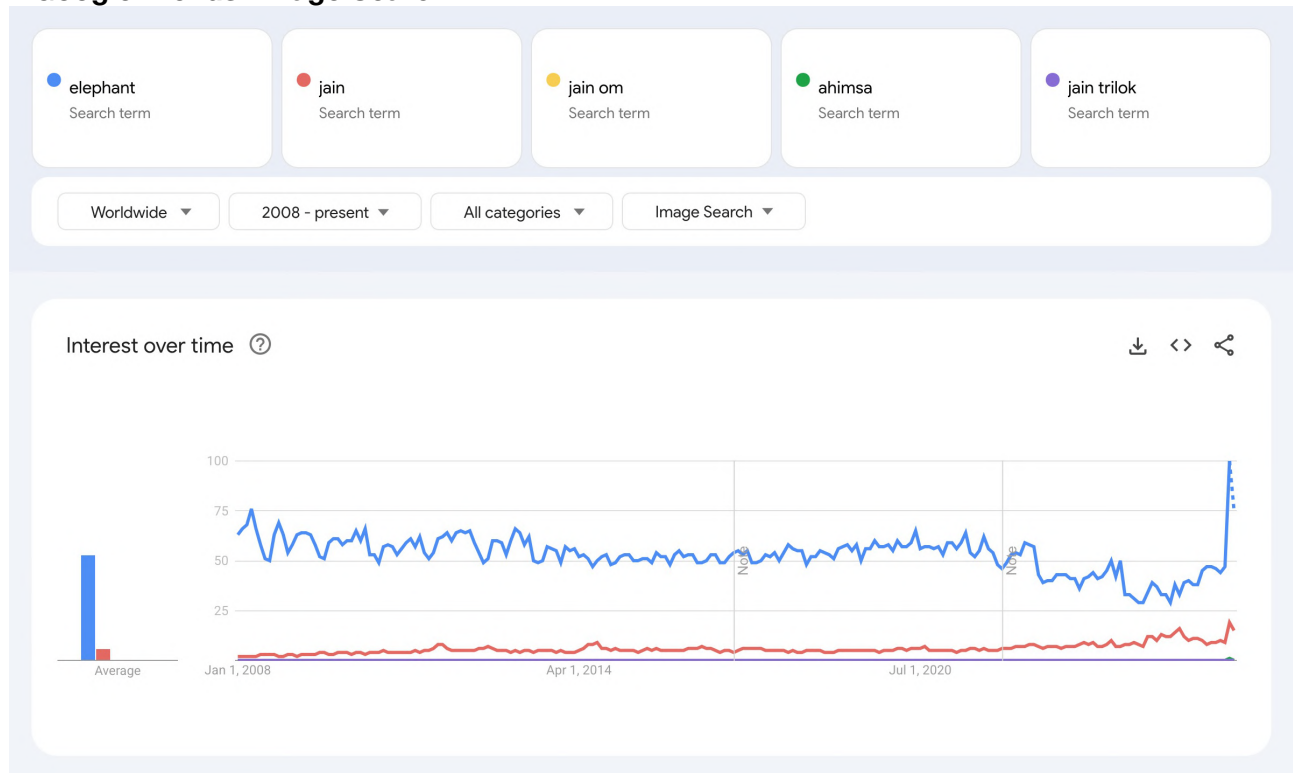
2004 - present ▾

All categories ▾

Web Search ▾



• Google Trends: Image Search

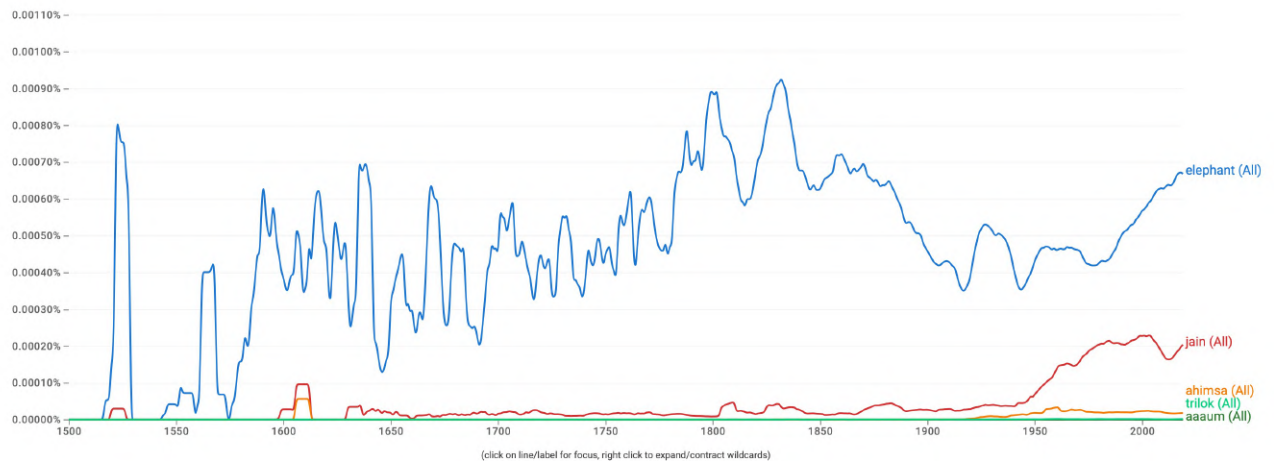


• Google Books: Ngram Viewer

Google Books Ngram Viewer

Search: X ?

1500 - 2019 English (2019) Case-Insensitive Smoothing



F. Completeness

Does the proposed emoji fill a gap in existing types of emoji?



JAIN AHIMSA HAND & JAIN OM CHARACTER

- **Yes.** Fills the gap of the religion symbols for Jainism, alongside Buddhism with the Dharmic wheel 🌀 (Wheel of Dharma, U+2638 U+FE0F), Hinduism with the Om symbol ॐ (Om, U+1F549 U+FE0F) and Sikhism with the and the Khanda ☸ (Khanda, U+1FAAF) which are all Dharmic religions.

G. Compatibility

Are these needed for compatibility with popular existing systems?



JAIN AHIMSA HAND & JAIN OM CHARACTER

- **No.**

4. Selection factors — Exclusion

A. Already representable

Can the concept be represented by another emoji or sequence, even if the image is not exactly the same?



JAIN AHIMSA HAND & JAIN OM CHARACTER

- **No.** Current religious symbols do not represent Jainism. Sequences such as 🙌 (Raised Hand with Fingers Splayed, U+1F590 U+FE0F) + 🌀 (Wheel of Dharma, U+2638 U+FE0F) fails to communicate the meaning of the Jain faith.

B. Overly specific

Is the proposed character overly specific?



JAIN AHIMSA HAND & JAIN OM CHARACTER

- **No.** These symbols represents the Jain faith in its entirety.

C. Open-ended

Is it just one of many, with no special reason to favor it over others of that type?



JAIN AHIMSA HAND & JAIN OM CHARACTER

- **No.** As Jainism is one of the oldest major religions, it completes the set of Dharmic religions (incl. Buddhism, Hinduism and Sikhism) rather than a niche community request.

D. Transient

Is the expected level of usage likely to continue into the future, or could it just be a fad?



JAIN AHIMSA HAND & JAIN OM CHARACTER

- **No.** Jainism dates back from at least 2500 years ago, rooted in ancient texts and depictions. Its relevance is permanent.

F. Faulty comparison

Are proposals being justified primarily by being similar to (or more important than) existing emoji?



JAIN AHIMSA HAND & JAIN OM CHARACTER

- **No.** This set of emoji proposals justifies its existence by filling a gap in the "religion" emoji category. It would provide 4,000,000 to 6,000,000 people a mean to express their religious identity that cannot be fulfilled by any other existing Unicode character.

5. Other information

A. Introduction

Jainism is one of the world's oldest independent religions still carrying on today. It originated thousands of years ago, in the 9th-8th century BCE. Its history traces the lineage of 24 Tirthankaras, while the last one Mahaaviira from the 6th century BCE is widely accepted as an historical figure. It is a framework for religion, rites and philosophy, with beliefs such as honesty, compassion, and especially non-violence called *Ahimsa*. Despite its community ranging from 4,000,000 to 6,000,000 people—comparable to other represented faiths—the current Unicode Emoji library lacks any standalone symbolism of the Jain religion.

This proposed set of two emojis aims to represent basic symbolism especially for Jains, mainly for South and South-East Asians along with the global non-violence and ethical living communities. These propositions don't aim to be exhaustive of all Jain symbols, but including one of them in the Unicode Emoji library would fulfill basic online communication needs for Jains.

B. Selection process

As Jainism carries a history of more than two millennia, we selected a set of two emojis meaningful for Jains and beyond. These symbols are the most inclusive for numerous people across three main categories:

- **Religion:** Recognizing these symbols in modern standards aims to provide Jains with purposeful representation of their faith;
- **Ethical philosophy:** Jainism philosophy is strongly compatible with modern concerns about non-violence and ethical movements, and the meaning of these symbols aren't currently represented within the current set of the Unicode Emoji library;

- **Culture:** These designs are cultural pillars for Jainism and Dharmic faiths but are also used in non-religious contexts. Traditionally used in many artistic and decorative purposes, this proposal aims to communicate common symbols of South and South-East Asian culture.

C. Prioritization

Even if this proposal contains two different emojis, the submitters along with representatives of the Jain community kindly request the Unicode Consortium to include a single emoji to the emoji library. The proposal features them in this order of importance:



JAIN HIMSA HAND (Most important)



JAIN OM CHARACTER

The Ahimsa hand is not only featured in the Jain Trilok symbol itself (formally approved during the 1974 unification as the official non-sectarian emblem of Jainism), but also in numerous designs and sculptures from the Jain community.

The Jain Om (Aaum) character is featured in numerous designs and sculptures from the Jain community.

D. Endorsement

This proposal has been reviewed and approved by the Institute of Jainology (<https://www.jainology.org>) with the following comments:

“We are pleased to see this initiative to secure a Jain emoji and have reviewed the proposed designs. Of these, we would suggest that the hand symbol with Ahimsa imprinted in the palm would be the most universally recognised Jain symbol and would work particularly well as an emoji. Our second preference would be the Jain Aum symbol.”